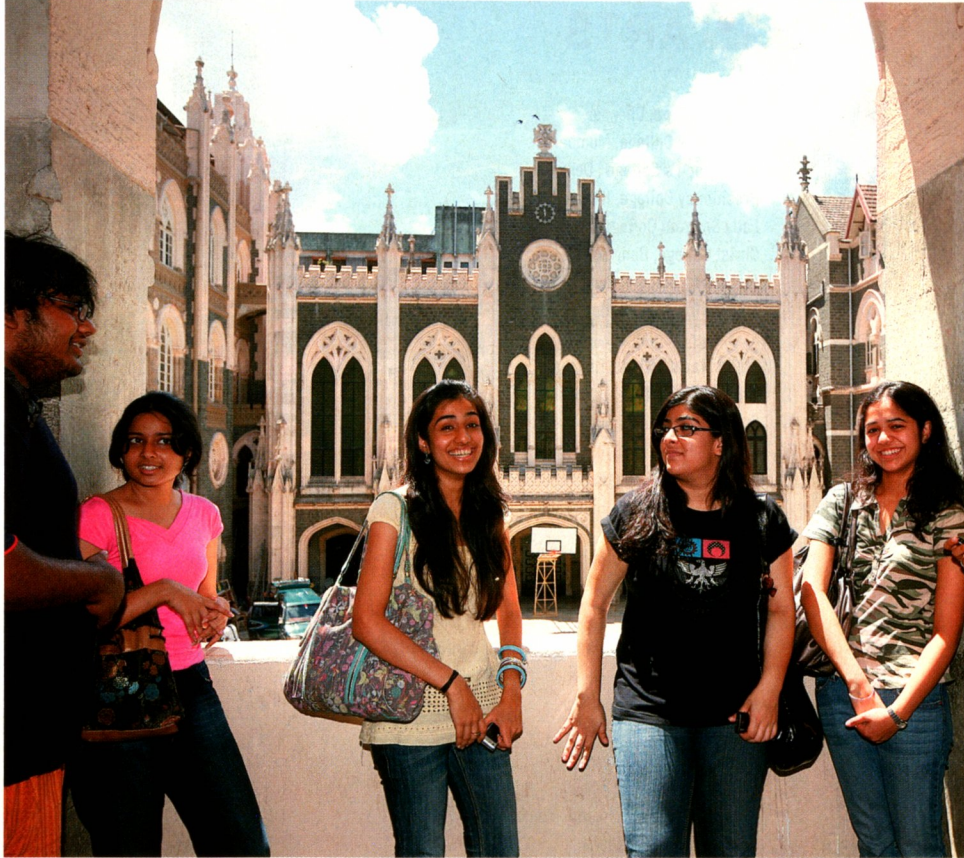


GIRISH GV



BHASKAR PAUL



CHARTBUSTERS: Students of Chennai's Loyola College (left); St. Xavier's, Mumbai

two years ago when 12 students from the Tamil literature department enacted 13 stories from the Bible for 72 hours at a stretch.

A consistent topper in the INDIA TODAY college survey, Loyola has always laid emphasis on the overall development of its students, covering not just the academics and extra-curricular activities like sports but instilling a sense of social responsibilities in students as well. The college library houses 1,02,000 books and 225 journals with its digital wing ensuring 24X7 access.

In what has been a pioneering

trend, Loyola encourages an inter-disciplinary approach towards social sciences. "This is being fast replicated by other educational institutions. Social science cannot be understood from a fragmentary perspective. Sociology, or any other arts subject for that matter, cannot exist in isolation. This unificatory approach is a vital step ahead," says Bernard D'Sami, co-ordinator, internal quality assurance cell and former head, history department, Loyola. In fact, last March, the college conducted a national-level social science conference in a bid to create a think-

tank on the unification of social sciences. Veteran sociologist T.K. Oomen chaired the conference.

However, the primary emphasis at Loyola is on academics. The arts stream encompass a wide range of subjects including history, economics, literature, sociology, community development, human resource management, medical and psychiatric social work and human rights. Loyola also offers specialised training in a host of Oriental and European languages along with Indian languages like Malayalam, Telugu and Sanskrit. The

The advertisement features three airplane tails from the US, India, and Japan. The text reads: "Where in the world would you like to work? THEY CHASE. YOU CHOOSE." and "INDUSTRY ENDORSED GNIIT". The NIIT logo is also present.

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